job and even though it was temporary, I wasn't eligible for relief anymore. I just can't afford to take another job."

Later on, thanks again to his party connections, Jack was placed in charge of the Works Progress Administration office in Dixon. The WPA was one of the most productive elements of FDR's alphabet soup of agencies because it put people to work building roads, bridges, and other projects. Like Jack's informal program, it gave men and women a chance to make some money along with the satisfaction of knowing they *earned* it. But just as Jack got the program up and running, there was a decline in the number of people applying for work on the projects. Since he knew there hadn't been a cure for unemployment in Dixon, he began asking questions and discovered the federal welfare workers were telling able-bodied men in Dixon that they shouldn't take the WPA jobs because they were being taken care of and didn't need help from the WPA.

After a while, Jack couldn't get any of his projects going; he couldn't get enough men sprung from the welfare giveaway program. I wasn't sophisticated enough to realize what I learned later: The first rule of a bureaucracy is to protect the bureaucracy. If the people running the welfare program had let their clientele find other ways of making a living, that would have reduced their importance and their budget.

The winter of 1932-1933 was very cold. Like a lot of other people in Dixon, I spent Christmas and New Year's out of work and without prospects. The only job on the horizon was another summer of lifeguarding at Lowell Park. In February, however, I got a telephone call that changed everything: Pete MacArthur said one of WOC's two staff announcers had quit and he offered me his job, starting at $100 a month.

"I'll be there tomorrow," I said.

Nelle had taught me to contribute ten percent of my income to the church and I'd always done so. As soon as I